The Dark Sparrow Eats

Family recipes, written down to cook from

How to Add and Edit Recipes

A guide for family and friends who help fill the recipe box

Thanks for helping! You can add recipes and fix them later, right from the website, on a phone or a computer. You don't need an account.

What you need

The website: recipes.the-dark-sparro.workers.dev

The owner code: a short password Art will send you separately. You need it each time you save. Please don't share it or post it anywhere.

Everything starts from the **Add a recipe** button at the top right of every page. There are three ways to add a recipe:



The red bar at the top of the site. "Add a recipe" is on the right (it says "Add" on a phone).

From a link

The recipe is on another website. Paste its address and the details fill in.

Page 2

From a photo

A recipe card, handwritten note, or cookbook page. Snap it and the site reads it.

Page 3

Type it in

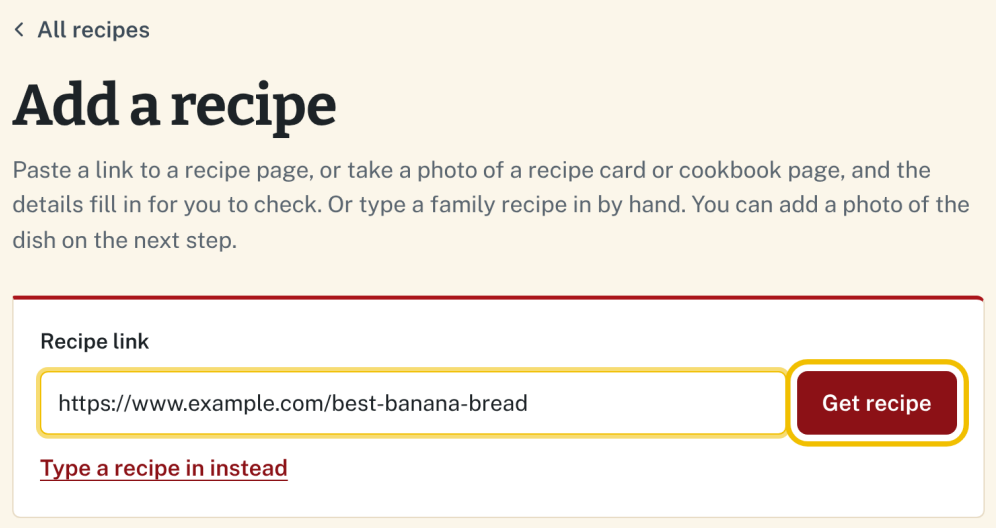
A family recipe in your head or on paper. Fill in the form yourself.

Page 5

Add a recipe from a link

Use this when the recipe is on another website.

1. Open the recipe on that website and copy the address from your browser's address bar. It starts with https://.
2. On our site, click **Add a recipe**, paste the address into **Recipe link**, and click **Get recipe**.
3. The form below fills in with the title, ingredients, and steps. Check them, and fix anything that came in wrong.
4. Enter the owner code and click **Save recipe**.



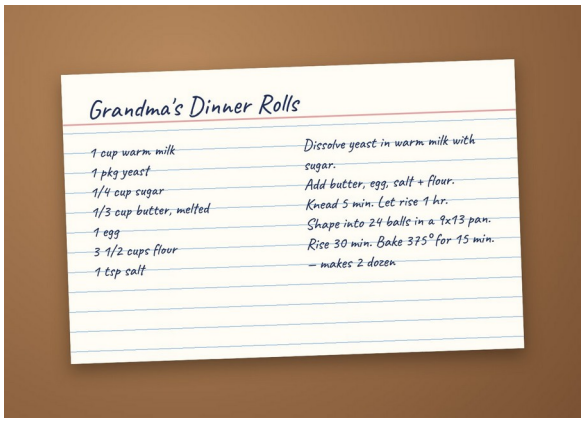
Paste the link, then click Get recipe.

> **Some websites don't allow this.** If yours doesn't, the address goes into the Source box and you type in the rest yourself. Steps copied from another site are that cook's own words, so it's good to rewrite them in yours. The original site is credited on the recipe page either way.

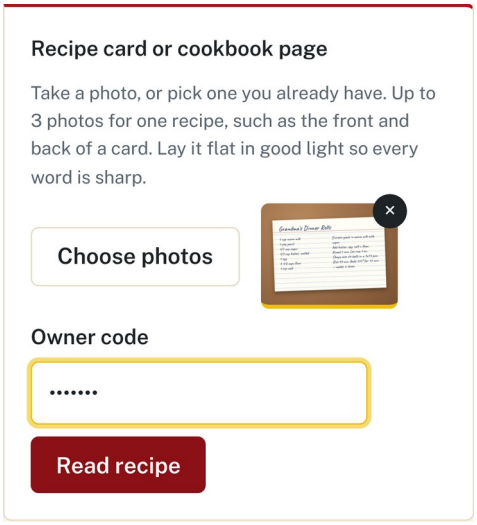
Add a recipe from a photo

Use this for a recipe card, a handwritten note, or a page in a cookbook. The site reads the writing and fills in the form for you.

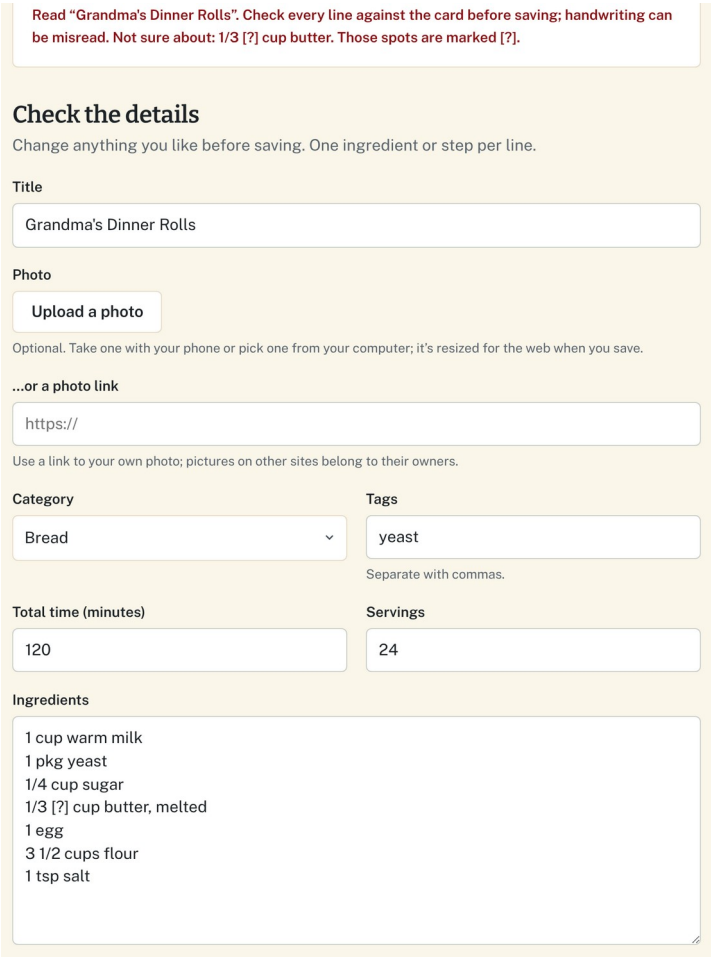
1. Lay the card or page flat in good light, and hold the camera straight over it so every word is sharp.
2. On **Add a recipe**, under **Recipe card or cookbook page**, click **Choose photos**. On a phone you can take the picture right there, or pick one you already have. Up to 3 photos make one recipe, such as the front and back of a card.
3. Enter the owner code and click **Read recipe**. Reading takes up to a minute.
4. The form fills in. **Check every line against the card**, because handwriting can be misread. Anything the reader wasn't sure of is marked [?], so look for those first.
5. Click **Save recipe**.



1. A good photo: flat, straight on, in good light.



2. On a phone: choose the photo, enter the code, tap Read recipe.

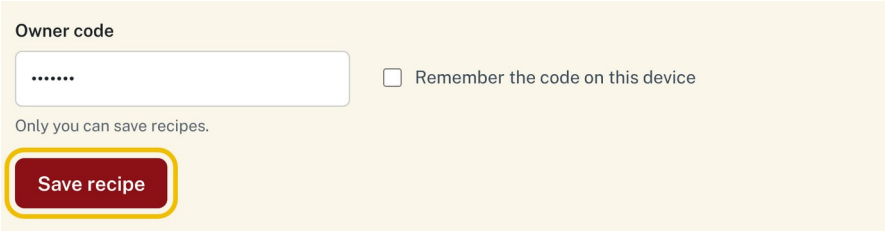


3. The form fills in. Here the reader wasn’t sure of one amount, so it’s marked [?] to check.

> **Good to know.** This reads the recipe text only; the card photo isn’t saved. To show a picture of the finished dish, add it with **Upload a photo** in the form. There’s a limit of 50 photo reads a day for everyone combined, so please read each recipe once.

Type a recipe in by hand

1. On **Add a recipe**, click **Type a recipe in instead** under the link box.
2. Fill in the form:
   - **Title**, the only required field.
   - **Photo** of the finished dish (optional). Click **Upload a photo** to take or pick one; it's resized for you.
   - **Category:** pick one from the list, or choose **New category…** only if nothing fits.
   - **Tags:** a few words separated by commas, like *beef, slow cooker*.
   - **Total time** in minutes, and **Servings** as a number or range, like *4* or *6-8*.
   - **Ingredients:** one per line, with the amount, like *2 cups flour*.
   - **Method:** one step per line. Leave out the step numbers; the site adds them.
   - **Cook's notes:** who the recipe came from, serving ideas, or tips.
3. Enter the owner code and click **Save recipe**. The recipe opens so you can see how it looks.



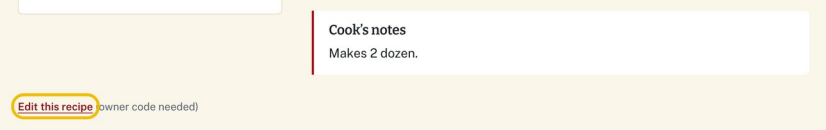
The bottom of every form: enter the owner code, then save.

Edit a recipe

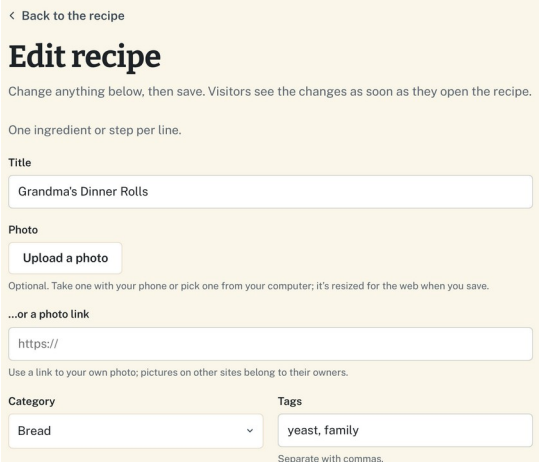
You can fix any recipe on the site, including ones you didn't add.

1. Open the recipe and scroll to the bottom of the page.
2. Click **Edit this recipe**. The form opens already filled in.
3. Change what you need. To replace the dish photo, click **Upload a photo**; to take it away, click **Remove photo**.
4. Enter the owner code and click **Save changes**. Click **Cancel** to leave without changing anything.

Please change only recipes you know. Fix typos and add tips freely, but check with Art before rewriting someone else's family recipe.

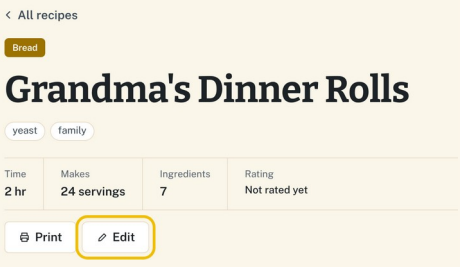


"Edit this recipe" is at the bottom of every recipe.



The edit form opens with everything already filled in.

A shortcut on your own devices. Tick **Remember the code on this device** when you save, and you won't have to type the code again on that phone or computer. An **Edit** button also appears next to **Print** at the top of every recipe there. Only tick it on your own devices.



If something goes wrong

Nothing is saved until you click Save, so you can always start over. Messages appear in red just under the button you clicked.

If you see…	Do this
That owner code isn't right	Check the code Art sent you, including capital letters, and try again.
Too many wrong codes were tried	Saving is paused for 10 minutes. Wait, then try again with the right code.
That photo doesn't look like a recipe	Take a closer, sharper photo in better light, then try again.
That's today's limit of photo reads	Try again tomorrow, or type the recipe in by hand.
Anything else	Wait a minute and try again. If it keeps happening, send Art a screenshot of the message.



Thank you for cooking with us.

Questions or ideas for the site? Ask Art.